



Build-Along: Prompt Improver Agent

Talk like a human. Get a ReFLECT-structured prompt back. Paste and go. A meta-agent that shapes the prompts every other agent in your tenant runs on.

What you'll build

A reusable Copilot agent that takes a plain-English ask, scores it against the seven ReFLECT elements, asks targeted questions only where elements are Partial or Missing, then returns an oven-ready prompt the user can paste into any other agent's Instructions or save as a starter prompt. Built once, used every time anyone in the team writes a new prompt.

ReFLECT — the seven elements

The prompt-engineering framework the Improver scores against and produces against. Every good agent prompt covers all seven.

R **ROLE** The agent's persona and posture (e.g. internal analyst).
e **EXPLICIT** The task itself, with success criteria.
F **FORMAT** Output shape – doc / deck / sheet, sections, length.
L **LIMITATIONS** Guardrails – constraints, what NOT to do, refusal rules.
E **EXAMPLES** A reference file or worked output to match in shape.
C **CONTEXT** Audience, standards, policies, thresholds, time, scope.
T **TONE** Voice – exec / neutral, informal, technical, action-led.

Session at a glance

Platform	m365.cloud.microsoft → Copilot → Agent Builder
Length	60 minutes (40 build & test, 15 worked example, 5 share)
Audience	Any role that writes recurring prompts — analysts, PMs, ops, comms
Format	Hands-on — every participant builds their own Improver
Deliverable	A working Prompt Improver Agent + your first ReFLECT prompt

Prerequisites — confirm BEFORE you start

- Access to m365.cloud.microsoft signed in with your work account
- Access to Copilot Agent Builder in your tenant
- A real, recurring task you own — bring your worst current prompt as the test case
- Optional: your team's standards, conventions, and defaults ready to type into ReFLECT Context

The Workflow Loop

Four steps from plain English to a pasted-and-running prompt. This is the loop the user runs every time they need a new prompt.

1 Talk like a human

Open the Prompt Improver Agent. Describe what you want in plain English. "I need to write a weekly status update for our project." No ReFLECT jargon required.

2 Answer its questions

The Improver scores the input against ReFLECT and asks targeted questions only where elements are Partial or Missing. Answer them in one go.

3 Get the oven-ready prompt

The Improver returns a full ReFLECT-structured prompt with checks and your team's conventions baked in. Copy it.

4 Paste and go

Paste into the target agent's Instructions or save it as a starter prompt. Drive day-to-day with short triggers — "run for this week", "run for region EMEA", "rerun with latest data".

Three Starter Prompts

Pinned on the Improver — what the user clicks to begin a session.

Assess my prompt

Paste any prompt to get a structured ReFLECT quality review.

Fill gaps in my prompt

Share a draft prompt. The Improver asks targeted questions to fill missing elements.

Show ReFLECT example

Ask for a worked example for a common task, demonstrating each ReFLECT element.

How it fits with the other agents

Build the Improver once. Then for every new agent you build, run the draft Instructions or starter prompts through it before you save them. Re-run live agents' Instructions through it at quarterly review — vague language and gaps creep in.

Build Steps — Open Builder & Identity

Get into Agent Builder, give the agent a clear name, description, and icon so it's instantly findable.

1 Open Agent Builder

Agent Builder lives inside the Copilot app. The Configure tab gives you full control over name, instructions, knowledge, and starter prompts.

```
m365.cloud.microsoft → Copilot (left rail)
  Top-right of the chat pane → Create agent
    → Agent Builder opens.
```

Two tabs at the top:

Describe – natural language setup (skip for this build)
Configure – form fields with full control ← pick this one

2 Name, description & icon

Name and description are what users see in the agent picker. The description doubles as a 'when to use me' note so colleagues you share with know exactly what the agent is for.

Name:

Prompt Improver Agent

Description:

Turns plain-English asks into ReFLECT-structured prompts you can paste into any other agent. Scores against ROLE / EXPLICIT TASK / FORMAT / LIMITATIONS / EXAMPLES / CONTEXT / TONE, asks only the questions needed to fill gaps, and returns an oven-ready prompt with checks built in.

Icon:

Click the avatar → pick a sparkle / wand / lightbulb glyph,
or upload a small PNG (square, transparent background).

Naming tip

Keep the word 'Agent' in the display name. Once your tenant has the Improver plus several other agents in the picker, the suffix instantly distinguishes them from people, files, and channels.

Build Steps — Instructions (the ReFLECT brain)

The Instructions field is the agent's entire personality and workflow. Paste this verbatim — every line earns its place.

3 Paste the ReFLECT Instructions block

Four numbered steps for the workflow; six rules to keep it on-rails. The agent scores against ReFLECT, asks only what's missing, returns a structured prompt, and stops there — it does not do the task itself.

You are the Prompt Improver Agent. You turn plain-English requests into structured ReFLECT prompts the user can paste into another agent. You do NOT do the work itself — you only shape the prompt for the agent that will.

ReFLECT — the seven elements every good prompt must cover:

- R ROLE Persona and posture the target agent should adopt.
- e EXPLICIT The task itself, with success criteria.
- F FORMAT Doc / deck / sheet, sections, length.
- L LIMITATIONS Guardrails, constraints, what NOT to do, refusal rules.
- E EXAMPLES Reference file or prior output to match.
- C CONTEXT Audience, standards, policies, thresholds, time, scope.
- T TONE Voice — exec / neutral, informal, technical, action-led.

WHEN THE USER GIVES YOU A PROMPT OR A PLAIN-ENGLISH DESCRIPTION:

1. Score each ReFLECT element as Complete / Partial / Missing in a short table. One line per element.
2. Ask targeted questions ONLY for Partial or Missing elements. Group them so the user can answer in one go. Never ask about elements already Complete.
3. Once you have answers, return the OVEN-READY PROMPT in a fenced code block, organised under the seven ReFLECT headings, with checks and the user's conventions baked in where relevant.
4. Suggest three short DAY-TO-DAY TRIGGERS the user can type once the prompt is saved (e.g. "run for this week", "run for region EMEA", "rerun with latest data").

RULES:

- Never do the underlying task. You only shape the prompt.
- Match the user's domain language, standards, and conventions in the output.
- If the user pastes an existing prompt, score it against ReFLECT first, then rewrite it filling gaps. Do not reorder elements they already got right.
- Keep responses tight — table, questions, finished prompt. No filler.
- Identify yourself as the Prompt Improver Agent if asked.
- Decline politely for anything outside prompt shaping.

Build Steps — Starters & Knowledge

Add the three pinned starters so first-time users have an on-ramp, then optionally teach the agent your firm's house style.

4 Suggested starter prompts

Conversation starters appear in the chat surface the moment a user opens the agent. These three cover the main jobs.

Under Conversation starters (or Suggested prompts), add:

1. Assess my prompt
"Paste any prompt to get a ReFLECT review."
2. Fill gaps in my prompt
"Share a draft prompt. I will ask targeted questions to fill missing elements, then return the ReFLECT version."
3. Show ReFLECT example
"Ask for a worked example for a common task – I will demonstrate each ReFLECT element."

5 Knowledge — house style (optional)

Upload a short reference file so the prompts the Improver produces match your team's conventions. Skip this step for a generic Improver — it still works.

Create `house_style.md` (or `.docx`) with four sections:

Standards & scope:

e.g. UK English, company tone of voice, brand guidelines URL, target audience defaults.

Thresholds & defaults:

e.g. status reports max 1 page, exec summaries max 5 bullets, decimal places, date format ISO (YYYY-MM-DD).

Output conventions:

Standard sections to include (e.g. Summary / Detail / Next steps), file naming pattern, where the output is saved.

GOOD EXAMPLE 1 / GOOD EXAMPLE 2:

Paste two ReFLECT prompts your team has used that worked well. Label them so the agent can pattern-match.

Upload:

Knowledge → Files → Add file → pick `house_style.md`

Test, Save & Share

Verify the ReFLECT behaviour in the live test pane, save the agent, and choose a sharing scope that matches your confidence.

6 Test in the right pane

Agent Builder has a live test pane on the right. Try a deliberately vague ask. The Improver should score, ask only what's missing, then return a structured ReFLECT prompt with day-to-day triggers.

Try in the test pane:

"I need to write a weekly status update for our project."

Expect to see:

- A short ReFLECT scoring table (Complete / Partial / Missing)
- A grouped set of questions for the gaps (role? audience? template? limitations? tone?)
- A fenced code block with the oven-ready prompt under R/e/F/L/E/C/T
- Three day-to-day triggers ("run for this week", "run for EMEA")

If the Improver tries to ACTUALLY write the status update, your Instructions did not stick – re-paste step 3 and retest.

7 Save & share

Start tight, widen later. Once shared, the agent appears in the recipient's Agents list — they can pin it for one-click access.

Top-right → Create (or Save)

Share scope:

Just me – while you're tuning
Specific people – your team
Everyone in your org – only after sign-off

After sharing:

Recipients open Copilot → Agents → pin Prompt Improver Agent.

Worked Example — Weekly Status Update

What the user says in plain English vs. the ReFLECT prompt the Improver gives back. Use this as the demo script.

WHAT YOU SAY TO THE IMPROVER

"I need to write a weekly status update for our project. It goes to the steering committee. We have a one-page template. I pull data from the project tracker and the budget sheet."

WHAT THE IMPROVER GIVES BACK

- R ROLE**
Internal project manager preparing the weekly status pack.
- e EXPLICIT**
Produce a one-page weekly status update covering progress, risks, blockers, and the plan for next week.
- F FORMAT**
Word doc (.docx). Sections: Summary, Progress, Risks, Next steps. Max 1 page.
- L LIMITATIONS**
No speculative dates. Refuse if project_tracker.xlsx or budget.xlsx is missing. RAG ratings per company template only.
- E EXAMPLES**
prior_status.docx structure where available.
- C CONTEXT**
Steering committee execs; may be forwarded to sponsors. Friday end-of-day cutoff. Sources: project_tracker.xlsx, budget.xlsx.
- T TONE**
Neutral exec voice. Skim-friendly bullets, no hedging.

Day-to-day triggers — once the prompt is saved on your agent

From now on the user drives the agent with short triggers — they don't re-paste the full ReFLECT prompt. Examples: "run for this week", "run for region EMEA", "rerun with latest data".

Try These Live

Four prompts that exercise the corners of the Improver — use them in the demo and the team share-out.

Vague ask

"I need to write our team update for leadership."

NOTICE

The Improver should rate every ReFLECT element Partial or Missing and ask grouped questions (role, audience, template, limitations, tone) before producing a prompt.

Already-good prompt

Paste a ReFLECT-shaped prompt your team already uses.

NOTICE

Should rate most elements Complete, suggest only one tweak (often a missing Limitation or Tone line), and not rewrite from scratch.

Wrong tool

"Draft the launch comms plan and send it to the team."

NOTICE

The Improver must NOT draft or send the plan — it should produce a ReFLECT prompt that the user pastes into a Comms agent.

Quarterly hygiene

Paste the live Instructions from one of your other agents.

NOTICE

Catches drift — vague language, missing thresholds, no validation step. The Improver returns a tightened version to swap in.

What you just shipped

A reusable, shareable agent that turns plain-English asks into ReFLECT-structured prompts — scored, gap-filled, oven-ready to paste into any other agent's Instructions.

Same Improver shape scales across your function: use it before you save any new agent, and re-run live agents' Instructions through it at quarterly review to catch drift.

Next: pin it in your team's Copilot rail, run a 60-minute clinic where everyone brings their worst recurring prompt, and watch baseline prompt quality rise across the team in a single session.